to abolish the rule of the Dogra dynasty.[2] This demand was treasonous and the top leadership of the National Conference was arrested that year. Subsequently, however, the Maharaja may have hoped that, given his reconciliation with Abdullah in September 1947, Abdullah would let bygones be bygones. Further by acceding to India, the Dogra ruling family may have persuaded itself that it stood a better chance of staying in power than it would have by joining Pakistan. If the Maharaja believed both of these hypotheses, he was soon to be disillusioned.

Abdullah Alienates Nehru

Nehru must have been dismayed to discover that Abdullah had distinctly ambivalent views about the potential the state of Jammu and Kashmir would have with India and the larger world. Abdullah said many things to many people at different times, but careful analysis can reveal certain consistent threads in his actions and policies during the first phase of his government, which ended abruptly in August 1953. Most of these consistencies re-emerged during the government's second phase from 1975 until his death. These were sometimes paradoxical—Abdullah cannot be accused of profound and logically rigorous political thought. They did not, on the whole, coincide with the kind of ideas the seat of government at New Delhi deemed to be appropriate to the chief official of an Indian state.

In his seminal PhD thesis submitted to the University of Southampton, Rakesh Ankit has revealed that T. G. Sanjeevi Pillai, Director of IB, wrote a top-secret note to Nehru on the rampant presence of communists, and their conspiracy to stage a coup, in Kashmir, on 5 August 1948.[3] It was a damning critique on the Abdullah regime and dwelt on the manifestation of communism under its protection. Abdullah's actions were generating serious concerns in London as well. There were grave concerns about the spread of communism under Abdullah's rule. Whitehall read Abdullah's *Naya* Kashmir manifesto for a socialist Kashmir and realised that Grafftey-Smith's warnings about Abdullah's communist leanings were not unfounded. In June 1948, Noel-Baker had been informed about the peculiar